



Easy Homemade Fig Jam Recipe With Pectin for Perfectly Set Spreads

This fig jam recipe with pectin is a simple way to get a perfectly set, spreadable jam every time. I love how the pectin helps it thicken without long cooking, keeping fresh fig flavor bright. Great for breakfast or gift-giving!



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15 min

PREP



30 min

COOK



45 min

TOTAL



4

SERVINGS



Easy

DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- ☐ 4 cups fresh ripe figs, chopped
- ☐ 2 cups granulated sugar
- ☐ 1/4 cup freshly squeezed lemon juice
- ☐ 1 packet (1.75 oz) fruit pectin
- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon vanilla extract (optional)

Instructions

- 1** Start by washing and chopping the fresh figs into small pieces. This helps release their natural juices during cooking. Place the chopped figs in a large heavy-bottomed pot to prevent scorching. Add the lemon juice, which not only brightens the flavor but also helps activate the pectin later. Stir the mixture gently and let it sit for about 10 minutes to macerate, which softens the fruit and draws out more juice. This step is important because it ensures the jam will have a nice texture and flavor without needing excessive cooking time. ⌚ 15
- 2** Sprinkle the fruit pectin evenly over the fig mixture and stir it in well. Pectin is the natural thickening agent that will help the jam set quickly and with a glossy finish. Turn the heat to medium-high and bring the mixture to a full rolling boil, stirring constantly to prevent burning. Once boiling, add the sugar all at once and stir vigorously until fully dissolved. Keep boiling for 1-2 minutes more, maintaining the rolling boil, then remove from heat. This quick boil with pectin and sugar activates the gel formation, so don't rush or skip this step, or your jam might not set properly. ⌚ 10
- 3** If using vanilla extract, stir it in now for a subtle depth of flavor. Let the jam cool for a few minutes in the pot before transferring it into sterilized jars. This prevents cracking of the glass and helps the jam set evenly. Fill the jars leaving about 1/4 inch headspace, wipe rims clean, and seal tightly. Allow the jam to cool completely at room temperature before refrigerating. The jam will continue to thicken as it cools, reaching its perfect spreadable consistency within a few hours. ⌚ 10
- 4** Sterilize your jars and lids by boiling them in water for 10 minutes or running them through a hot dishwasher cycle. This step is crucial to prevent spoilage and ensure your jam stays fresh longer. Dry the jars on a clean towel before filling with jam. Using sterilized jars also helps avoid mold growth and keeps your jam safe for storage. ⌚ 15
- 5** Before serving, test the set of your jam by placing a small spoonful on a chilled plate and running your finger through it. If it wrinkles and holds shape, it's ready. If it's too runny, you can return the jam to the pot and boil for another minute before re-testing. This simple test helps you avoid disappointing runny jam and ensures your spread will have the perfect consistency. ⌚ 5
- 6** Store your sealed jars in the refrigerator for up to 3 weeks or freeze for longer storage. When freezing, leave extra headspace to allow for expansion. Thaw in the fridge overnight before using. Proper storage keeps your jam tasting fresh and safe to eat. ⌚ 5
- 7** For a smoother jam, you can lightly mash the figs with a potato masher before adding pectin. This breaks down the fruit more and creates a less chunky texture. It's a nice option if you prefer a more traditional jam consistency. ⌚ 5

- 8** Use a heavy-bottomed pot to cook the jam to prevent hot spots that cause burning. Stir frequently, especially during boiling, to maintain even heat distribution and avoid scorching the sugar. This ensures a clean, pure flavor without any bitter burnt notes. ⌚ 30
- 9** Allow the jam to cool completely before refrigerating or gifting. Cooling at room temperature helps the jam finish setting and thickening. Avoid refrigerating hot jam directly as condensation can cause spoilage or watery texture. ⌚ 20

Chef Tips

🔖 Use fresh, ripe figs for the best flavor and natural sweetness.

Ripe figs have higher sugar content and softer flesh, which breaks down more easily during cooking. This results in a naturally sweet, flavorful jam with a pleasant texture. Using underripe figs can lead to a tart or bland jam that requires more added sugar and longer cooking.

🔖 Stir constantly during boiling to prevent burning and scorching.

Jam mixtures are thick and high in sugar, which can easily burn on the bottom of the pot if left unstirred. Scorching imparts a bitter flavor and uneven texture. Constant stirring distributes heat evenly and helps dissolve sugar fully for a smooth, clean-tasting jam.

🔖 Sterilize jars properly to extend shelf life and prevent mold.

Jars that aren't sterilized can harbor bacteria or mold spores that spoil the jam quickly. Boiling jars and lids or using a hot dishwasher cycle kills these microbes. Proper sterilization ensures your jam stays fresh and safe for weeks or months.

Storage & Reheating

🔖 Refrigerator

Store opened jars in the refrigerator in an airtight container for up to 3 weeks. The jam may thicken further when chilled. Stir before serving if it becomes too firm.

❄️ Freezer

Freeze jam in freezer-safe containers for up to 3 months. Leave extra headspace to allow expansion. Thaw in the refrigerator overnight before use. Texture may soften slightly after freezing but remains delicious.

☑ Reheating

Jam does not require reheating but can be warmed gently in a saucepan or microwave if desired. Avoid boiling after setting to preserve texture and flavor.

Nutrition (per serving)

140 kcal CALORIES	1g PROTEIN	36g CARBS
0g FAT	3g FIBER	5mg SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredients used.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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